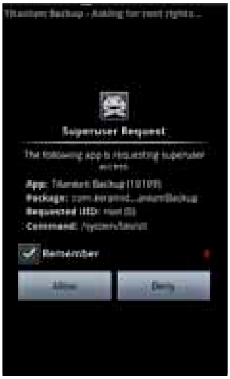
The Superuser app grants root permissions to apps

('spawned') by it. This init process has root priveleges as it is required to start other priveleged processes and services that are critical to the functioning of the device. Thus, during normal operation of an Android device, there exist background processes running as root. The key lies in being able to trick these processes into executing some code that will mount the /system partition as writeable, as well as permanently install the Superuser application. Most popular rooting methods use this technique. After the device has been rooted, any app that claims to require root access will basically try to start other priveleged apps (often bundled within the same app) using the su or Superuser app. When it tries to start su, the user is asked to grant or deny priveleged access to the app.

How do I root my Android device?

Android devices differ in many aspects, including the form factor, screen size, hardware features and most importantly, the build of Android they're currently running. The sheer variety in the exploits used to root a phone means that no single method is applicable to all devices running Android. The rooting procedure itself is a very simple one, and most methods require to either connect the phone to the computer and use a tool, which, with the press of a single button will root your device for you. There also exist methods where users don't need a computer, simply downloading an app and running the app should do the trick.

Some popular methods for rooting which apply to a large number of devices are Unlock Root, Gingerbreak, SuperOneClick and Universal Androot. However, if you wish to root your device, your best bet would be to look for a rooting method that has been tested to work on the same device running the same version of Android. This is because rooting methods differ from device to device and even between different versions of Android. There is really no 'one size fits all' technique for rooting.

One important thing to keep in mind is that rooting a phone qualifies as tampering with the phone's internal software, and this will, in most cases nullify the warranty on your device. There is also a slight risk of something going wrong and the phone becoming unusable. This doesn't